

R800 a month between them.

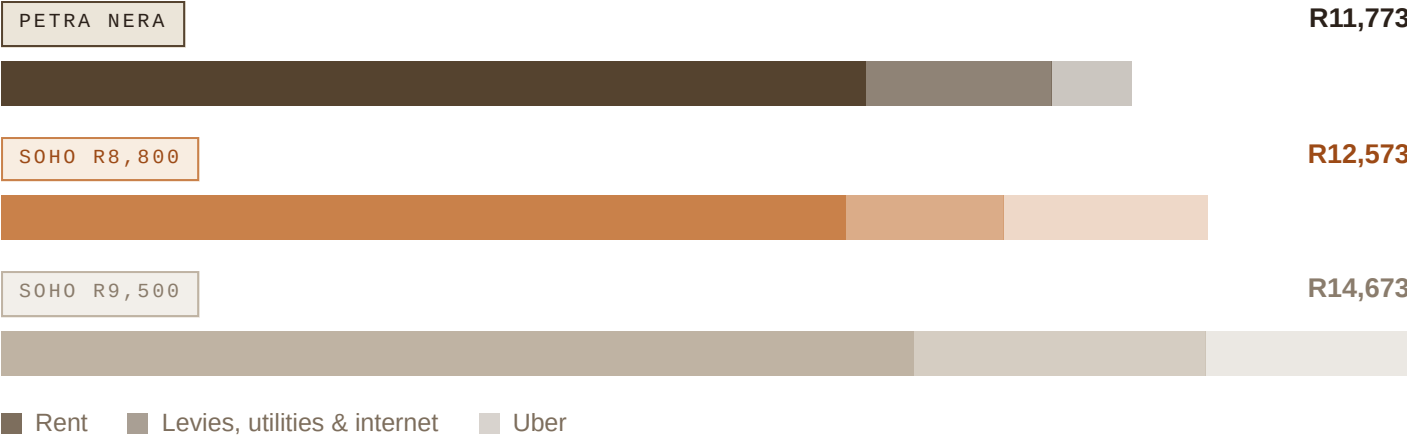
With no gym, Petra Nera is ahead by **R800 — R400 each**. Confirming that the R8,800 SoHo rent already covers sanitation, refuse and security took R1,400 off SoHo and turned a clear result into a close one. Take a gym membership and **SoHo goes ahead instead**.

PETRA NERA	SOHO @ R8,800	SOHO @ R9,500	YEAR-ONE DIFFERENCE
R11,773	R12,573	R14,673	R9,650
3 bed · walks to CRC	2 bed · levies included in rent	2 bed · levies billed on top	Petra Nera against SoHo R8,800 — R4,825 each

TABLE 1

Monthly cost

FULL MONTHLY COST — TWO PEOPLE, UBER FOR ALL TRAVEL, NO GYM MEMBERSHIP			
LINE ITEM	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800	SOHO R9,500
Rent	R9,000	R8,800	R9,500
Sanitation R8,800 unit: included in rent · R9,500 unit: billed on top	unknown	included	R900
Refuse & security R8,800 unit: included in rent · R9,500 unit: billed on top	unknown	included	R500
Electricity Petra Nera: your figure · SoHo: estimate, Table 8	R1,000	R650	R650
Water SoHo: prepaid sub-meter via STSS — estimate	R150	R200	R200
Internet uncapped fibre	R800	R800	R800
Housing subtotal	R10,950	R10,450	R12,550
Gym membership	R0 not taking one	R0 on site, unused	R0
Uber — CRC 13 round trips a month	R0 — walk	R1,300	R1,300
Uber — Wits 4.3 round trips a month	R823	R823	R823
Transport subtotal	R823	R2,123	R2,123
Monthly total	R11,773	R12,573	R14,673
Per person split equally — see Table 1a for the actual split	R5,887	R6,287	R7,337
Gap to Petra Nera	—	R800 R400 each	R2,900 R1,450 each



THE GYM NOW DECIDES IT

These figures assume **no gym membership either side**. That removes R650 of fees and R1,170 of Uber fares from Petra Nera — R1,820 a month — and it is why Petra Nera leads at all.

Reverse it and SoHo wins. If either of you takes a Planet Fitness membership, Petra Nera goes to R13,593 against SoHo’s R12,573 — **SoHo cheaper by R1,020 a month**, with the gym downstairs rather than a R45 Uber away. At R800 apart, this single decision is worth more than everything else on the page.

TABLE 1A

Who pays what

One person travels to CRC; the Wits fare is shared. An Uber costs the same with one passenger or two, so **the household totals do not change** — but the split between you does, and sharply.

MONTHLY COST PER PERSON – CRC BORNE BY THE TRAVELLER, EVERYTHING ELSE HALVED			
LINE	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800	SOHO R9,500
Housing, split equally rent, levies, utilities, internet	R5,475	R5,225	R6,275
Wits Uber, split one car, fare halved	R412	R412	R412
CRC Uber — traveller only 13 round trips a month	R0 — walk	R1,300	R1,300
The CRC traveller pays	R5,887	R6,937	R7,987
The other person pays	R5,887	R5,637	R6,686
Household total	R11,773	R12,573	R14,673
If instead you split everything equally	R5,887 each	R6,287 each	R7,337 each

THE COST LANDS ON ONE PERSON

Moving to the R8,800 SoHo unit costs the **CRC traveller R1,050 a month more** than Petra Nera — while the other person actually pays **R250 less**. The whole of SoHo's extra cost, and then some, falls on whoever makes the church run.

Worth saying out loud before you choose: at Petra Nera you each pay the same R5,887, because the walk is free. At SoHo it splits R6,937 against R5,637 — so the non-traveller is better off there and the traveller is worse off. Worth agreeing how to handle that before signing.

WHY THE TOTALS DID NOT MOVE

Uber prices the *trip*, not the seat. One person to CRC costs the same R50 each way as two, and sharing the Wits car halves what each of you contributes without changing the R823 the household pays. So this refines **who owes what**, not what it costs — every other table on this page is unaffected.

TABLE 2

Transport

UBER — CRC MON, TUE, THU · WITS ON WEDNESDAYS				
TRIP	FARE EACH WAY	ROUND TRIPS PER MONTH	PETRA NERA	SOHO, EITHER UNIT
Home → CRC Johannesburg one person travels	R50 your figure	13	R0 — 6 min walk	R1,300
Home → Wits Braamfontein shared car, fare split	~R95 your figure	4.3	R823	R823
Monthly Uber spend			R823	R2,123
Difference			R1,300 a month — R15,600 a year — entirely the walk to CRC	

TABLES 3 AND 4

Move-in cash and year one

TABLE 3 – CASH NEEDED TO MOVE IN			
ITEM	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800	SOHO R9,500
Deposit refundable	R9,000	R9,000	R10,000
First month's rent	R9,000	R8,800	R9,500
Admin / lease initiation	R2,000 confirmed — above market	~R1,250	~R1,250
Credit check	included?	~R300	~R300
Meter activation, tags	~R500	~R500	~R500
Fibre install + router	R0 – 1,800	R0 – 1,800	R0 – 1,800
Moving costs	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000
Cash needed	R23,500 – 28,300	R22,850 – 27,650	R24,550 – 29,350

TABLE 4 – YEAR-ONE TOTAL			
	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800	SOHO R9,500
Twelve months of running cost	R141,276	R150,876	R176,076
Non-refundable once-offs	~R7,400	~R7,450	~R7,450
Year-one cash out	~R148,700	~R158,300	~R183,500
Plus deposit held	R9,000	R9,000	R10,000
Difference vs Petra Nera	—	R9,650 R4,825 each	R34,850 R17,425 each

TABLE 5

The two SoHo units

SAME COMPLEX – SOHO JUNCTION, 4 POPLAR AVENUE, BROADACRES			
	R8,800	R9,500	NOTE
Rent	R8,800	R9,500	R700 a month — R8,400 a year
Deposit	R9,000	R10,000	R1,000 less up front
Parking	1 undercover carport	2 bays	The clearest loss — worth R250–R500 a month if either of you gets a car
Floor size	not stated	62 m²	Confirm. If it is materially smaller the saving is not free
Available	1 Aug 2026	1 Oct 2026	No gap, no overlap month, no storage
Pets	None	Cats only	—
Facilities	Pool, clubhouse, gym, sauna, steam room, business centre, 24-hour manned security, concierge, lifts		Developer-confirmed as complex facilities, so both units get all of it
Fittings	Gas hobs · central water heating · low-energy lights · inverter-ready		Complex-wide. This is why the electricity estimate is R650
Levies	included in rent	+ R1,400 on top	The decisive difference — worth more than the R700 of rent
All-in monthly	R12,573	R14,673	R2,100 apart. The R9,500 unit is only worth it for the second bay

TABLE 5A

Every SoHo Junction unit currently advertised

Swept across Property24 and Private Property, August 2026. **R8,800 is the cheapest two-bathroom unit in the complex** — the next is R3,200 dearer.

SOHO JUNCTION, 4 POPLAR AVENUE – LIVE RENTALS, CHEAPEST FIRST							
RENT		BED	BATH	SIZE	PARKING	AVAILABLE	LISTING
R7,800 reduced		1	1	48 m²	1	1 Sep	P24 110936543 too small for two
R8,800		2	2	not stated	1 carport	Now	P24 112143116 your find — levies included in rent
R9,100 + R399 refuse + R890.65 effluent		2	1	—	1	16 Jul	P24 117418093 one bathroom · STSS prepaid
R9,500		2	1	—	—	1 Jul	P24 117336994 pet-friendly, 2nd floor
R10,000		2	1	—	—	1 Aug	P24 117458457 ground floor
R10,000		2	1	77 m²	2	Now	Private Property RR4733075 eXp South Africa
R10,500 headline R9,500 base + R1,400 charges		2	2	62 m²	2 bays	1 Oct	P24 117458624 the one you started with
R12,000		2	2	—	2	1 Aug	P24 117329860 east-facing, no pets
R13,000		3	2	87 m²	1 + 1	26 May	P24 117255782 corner unit

ANSWER: NO, THERE IS
NOTHING BETTER

Everything cheaper than R8,800 in this complex has **one bathroom or one bedroom**. The next two-bathroom unit up is the R10,500 headline one you started with, then R12,000. For a 2-bed 2-bath, **R8,800 is the floor at SoHo Junction** — and it is available now.

COULD THE R8,800 HAVE NO
CHARGES AT ALL?

Almost certainly not. The charges exist at **scheme level** — sale listings show sewerage of R704.47 inside the levy and refuse of R353.05 inside the rates, so the body corporate incurs them on every unit. The only question is who pays: the landlord absorbs them into the rent, or bills them on top. **Two other SoHo landlords bill them on top**, and the R8,800 advert does mention prepaid electricity — so it is not silent on utilities, just brief on levies. The ladder below is the strongest evidence.

TABLE 5B

Resolved: the R8,800 includes the levies

Confirmed with the agent. R8,800 covers sanitation, refuse and security — everything except water and electricity.

THE TWO SOHO UNITS ON THE SAME ALL-IN FOOTING				
UNIT	ADVERTISED	LEVIES	+ WATER & ELECTRICITY	HOUSING ALL-IN
2 bed 2 bath — 1 carport — yours	R8,800	included	R850	R9,650
2 bed 2 bath — 62 m², 2 bays	R9,500	+ R1,400	R850	R11,750
2 bed 1 bath	R9,100	+ R1,290	R850	R11,240
The R8,800 unit is cheaper than the R9,500 one by		R2,100 a month — R25,200 a year — on R700 of headline rent difference		

I CALLED THIS WRONG

The previous version argued R8,800 was base rent, on three grounds: that reading it as all-in would undercut every other unit in the complex, that the R9,000 deposit matched R8,800 at 1.02×, and that the advert mentioned prepaid electricity so was describing utilities. **All three were reasonable and the conclusion was wrong.** The levies are in the rent. The arithmetic for that branch was right — it predicted R12,573 and an R800 gap, which is exactly where this lands.

WHAT IT CHANGES

SoHo R8,800 drops from R13,973 to **R12,573**, and the gap to Petra Nera narrows from R2,200 to **R800 a month — R400 each**. Over a year, R9,650 rather than R26,450.

It also makes the R8,800 unit **far better value than the R9,500 one** — R2,100 a month apart on all-in cost, from R700 of rent difference. The R9,500 unit is now only worth considering for its second parking bay and confirmed 62 m².

TABLE 6

What would change the answer

PETRA NERA AGAINST SOHO R8,800 — EACH SCENARIO ON ITS OWN			
IF...	PETRA NERA	SOHO R8,800	GAP
Base case — as tabled	R11,773	R12,573	R800
SoHo electricity is R900, not R650	R11,773	R12,823	R1,050
SoHo water is R350, not R200	R11,773	R12,723	R950
SoHo electricity is R500	R11,773	R12,423	R650
Petra Nera electricity is R1,300	R12,073	R12,573	R500
Petra Nera bills sanitation and refuse on top, at R700	R12,473	R12,573	R100 effectively level
Petra Nera bills them at R1,400 the rate the R9,500 SoHo unit charges	R13,173	R12,573	−R600 — SoHo cheaper
You later join a gym R650 membership + R1,170 Uber at Petra Nera; free at SoHo	R13,593	R12,573	−R1,020 — SoHo cheaper

IT IS A REAL CONTEST AGAIN

At R800 a month — R400 each — two plausible scenarios now put **SoHo ahead**: Petra Nera billing sanitation and refuse at the R1,400 the other SoHo unit charges, or either of you taking a gym membership. A third, Petra Nera billing them at R700, leaves the two level at R100.

The single most valuable thing you can still do is **ask Petra Nera whether its R1,150 covers sanitation and refuse**. SoHo has now answered that question; Petra Nera has not.

TABLE 7

Other 2-bed, 2-bath options

Rents quoted from live listings; levies and utilities modelled. None is competitive.

WIDER SEARCH — FOURWAYS, BROADACRES, DOUGLASDALE, DAINFERN, SUNNINGHILL				
COMPLEX	RENT	GYM ON SITE	MODELLED ALL-IN	VS PETRA NERA
Helderfontein Nexus 20 Broadacres Drive, Dainfern · 68 m² · internet included	R10,500	Yes	~R15,061	+R3,288
Kalgaro Lifestyle Estate Swallow Drive, Douglasdale · double carport · closest to CRC after Petra Nera	R10,500	Yes	~R15,493	+R3,720
Olea View 30 Cedar Avenue West, Fourways · 77 m² — largest found	R11,000	No	~R16,273	+R4,500
The Kanyin 109 Leeuwkop Road, Sunninghill · squash, two pools, creche	R11,000	Yes	~R16,383	+R4,610

Searched Fourways, Broadacres, Douglasdale, Dainfern, Sunninghill and Helderfontein for two-bed two-bath stock between roughly R8,000 and R11,500. Not exhaustive — most listings do not state bathrooms, levies or amenities, so filtering from the outside is unreliable. Lonehill, Craigavon and Bryanston were not covered in depth.

TABLE 8

SoHo electricity and water — the evidence

NO TENANT REVIEWS EXIST

I searched for resident reports of an actual bill and found none. **HelloPeter carries zero reviews** for SoHo Junction; there are no Google review threads, forum posts or MyBroadband discussions giving a figure, and no rental or sale listing states a rand amount for electricity. **R650 is a derived estimate, not a measurement**. The range below is real uncertainty, and one phone call to the estate manager would close it.

WHAT IS ACTUALLY DOCUMENTED		
FINDING	SOURCE	EFFECT ON THE ESTIMATE
Gas hobs complex-wide	Developer specification	Removes the cooking load — roughly 10% of a normal bill
Central water heating system	Developer specification, and the R9,500 rental listing	Removes the geyser — 30–40% of a normal bill. It sits on the body-corporate account
Low-energy lights , inverter-ready	Developer specification	Small further reduction
Prepaid electricity meters	Both rental listings and sale listings	You buy units; no monthly account
Water and electricity are prepaid via STSS sub-metering	SoHo rental listing 117418093	Corrects an earlier reading. A sale listing said water sits in the levy — that is the owner's levy. Tenants do pay for water, so the estimate rose from R50 to R200
Levies quoted as refuse R399 + domestic effluent R890.65 = R1,289.65	SoHo rental listing 117418093	Second data point against the R900 + R500 = R1,400 on the R9,500 listing. The ~R110 difference is the security share. R1,400 is used here as the more conservative figure
2-bed levy R2,207.77 reserve fund R540.74 · sewerage R704.47 · CSOS R32.52 · water and maintenance included	Sale listing, 4 Poplar Avenue	The R900 tenant "sanitation" charge tracks the R704.47 sewerage line
2-bed rates R924.64 rates R572.59 · refuse R353.05	Sale listing, 4 Poplar Avenue	The R500 "refuse & security" charge tracks the R353.05 refuse line plus a security share
City Power 2026/27 prepaid domestic	City Power tariff schedule	R3.06–R4.37 per kWh. The ~R200 fixed charges sit on the scheme's bulk account, not your meter

HOW R650 IS DERIVED		
STEP	KWH / MONTH	AT R3.06–R4.37
Two-person flat, fully electric	300 – 450	—
Less electric geyser — central here	–30 to 40%	—
Less electric hob — gas here	–10%	—
Less lighting — LED here	–3%	—
Remaining: fridge, washer, oven, kettle, electronics, standby	150 – 250	R500 – R1,000
Estimate used	~190	R650
Cross-check — Petra Nera's actual	R1,000 for a larger flat heating its own water. Sits where this model predicts, which is the best corroboration available	

TABLE 9

Questions to ask

PETRA NERA 1. Are sanitation, sewerage and refuse billed on top of the R1,150, or included? Worth up to R1,400 a month. 2. If billed separately, what did they come to last month? 3. Can we see a recent utility bill, so the R1,150 is confirmed rather than estimated? 4. What does the R2,000 admin fee cover, and is it negotiable? Market rate is R950–R1,500. 5. What is the annual escalation percentage? 6. Security setup — guard, access control, CCTV, perimeter? 7. How many parking bays, covered or allocated? 8. Backup power and water storage during outages? 9. Age and condition of geyser, plumbing and roof — who pays for repairs? 10. Will the landlord contribute to repainting given the condition? 11. Exact walking route to the CRC entrance — is it lit at night? 12. When is it available, and is R9,000 held for a 12-month lease?	SOHO JUNCTION — R8,800 1. What is the floor size? The other unit in this complex is 62 m². 2. What does a two-bed here actually spend on prepaid electricity a month? Ask the estate manager or a current tenant. This is the last unverified number of any size. 3. Get the levy inclusion in writing in the lease — that sanitation, refuse and security are covered by the R8,800 and cannot be billed separately later. 4. If the body corporate raises those charges mid-lease, who absorbs the increase? 5. What does prepaid water actually cost here? It is sub-metered via STSS, so it is not in your levy. 6. Do the levies escalate annually, and by how much? 7. Is the carport allocated, and can a second bay be rented? At what cost? 8. What is the annual escalation percentage? 9. Any special levies planned? Can we see the last two AGM minutes and the reserve-fund balance? 10. Total once-off cost — admin, credit checks for two, tags, meter activation? 11. Deposit interest arrangement, and which account? 12. Generator or inverter for load-shedding, and water tanks for outages? 13. Early-cancellation penalty — can it be capped in writing? 14. Is it still available?
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TABLE 9A

Every listing referenced

All SoHo Junction links are in Table 5a. These are the rest.

OTHER COMPLEXES — LIVE LISTINGS				
COMPLEX	ADDRESS	RENT	BED / BATH	LISTING
Petra Nera	14 Riverbend Rd, Hoogland, Randburg	R9,000	3 / 2	No listing — your figures throughout
Kalgaro Lifestyle Estate	Swallow Drive, Douglasdale	R10,500	2 / 2	Private Property RR4722380
Olea View	30 Cedar Avenue West, Fourways	R11,000	2 / 2 · 77 m²	P24 117403762
Meander Lifestyle dropped from the comparison	1 Celery Drive, Treesbank AH, Midrand	R10,500	2 / 2 · 68 m²	P24 117368111
Helderfontein Nexus	20 Broadacres Drive, Dainfern	from R10,500	2 / 2 · 68 m²	P24 development page · Houss Rentals
The Kanyin	109 Leeuwkop Road, Sunninghill	R11,000–12,500	2 / 2	No verified link — found via search summary only. Search “The Kanyin Sunninghill” on Property24

BROWSE FOR YOURSELF — THE SEARCH PAGES USED	
SEARCH	LINK
Broadacres apartments to rent — Property24	property24.com/apartments-to-rent/broadacres 3 pages, ~50 listings — where most SoHo units appear
Fourways apartments to rent — Property24	property24.com/apartments-to-rent/fourways 8 pages, 147 listings
Douglasdale apartments to rent — Property24	property24.com/apartments-to-rent/douglasdale
Broadacres apartments — Private Property	privateproperty.co.za/apartments-to-rent/broadacres carries listings Property24 does not
Helderfontein Estate — Private Property	privateproperty.co.za — Helderfontein Estate

TABLE 10

Assumptions

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	SOURCE / CHANGE IT IF...
Occupancy	Two people	Third room at Petra Nera used as a study, not let
Who travels	One person to CRC Both to Wits, fare split	Uber prices the trip, not the seat, so totals are unchanged. See Table 1a for the per-person split
Gym	None	No membership either side. If you take one, see the last row of Table 6
Transport mode	Uber for everything	If either of you gets a car, SoHo's parking matters and the R9,500 unit's second bay comes into play
Uber — SoHo to CRC	R50 each way	Your figure
Uber — either flat to Wits	~R95 each way	Your figure — “just under R100”
CRC trips	13 round trips a month	Mon, Tue, Thu × 4.33 weeks
Wits trips	4.3 round trips a month	Wednesdays, no CRC on campus days
Internet	R800/month	Uncapped fibre runs R600–R900 in 2026. Both are fibre-ready, neither includes it
SoHo levies	R0 on the R8,800 unit R900 + R500 on the R9,500	Confirmed with the agent: R8,800 covers sanitation, refuse and security. The R9,500 listing bills them on top
SoHo electricity	R650	Derived — see Table 8. Range R500–R1,000
SoHo water	R200	Revised up from R50. A SoHo listing confirms water is prepaid sub-metered via STSS, so tenants do pay it. Range R100–R350
SoHo R8,800 floor size	Unknown	Not stated. The R9,500 unit is 62 m²
Petra Nera electricity / water	R1,000 / R150	Your figures
Petra Nera sanitation & refuse	Unknown	Worth up to R1,400 — the largest remaining uncertainty
Petra Nera deposit & admin	R9,000 + R2,000	Your figures
Weeks per month	4.33	—

SOURCES

- Property24 — SoHo Junction, Broadacres, R8,800 · SoHo Junction, Fourways, R9,500 — rent, deposit, levies, parking, amenities, availability
- OCC Property — SoHo Junction developer specification — gas hobs, central water heating, low-energy lights, inverter-ready; Activity Centre with gym, sauna, steam room and business centre
- Property24 sale listings, 4 Poplar Avenue — 2-bed levy R2,207.77 (reserve fund R540.74, sewerage R704.47, CSOS R32.52, water and maintenance included); rates R924.64 (rates R572.59, refuse R353.05)
- HelloPeter — SoHo Junction — zero reviews on file
- City Power 2026/27 tariffs — R3.06–R4.37/kWh incl. VAT, R70 service charge, R130 network capacity charge
- Water meters in sectional title schemes — bulk-metered schemes are billed on an inclining block tariff and reconciled per unit by the body corporate
- Private Property — Kalgaro, Swallow Drive · Olea View · Helderfontein Nexus
- CRC Johannesburg — cnr Witkoppen & Riverbend Road, Fourways